

PROJECT SOUTHEAST ASIA

Information Memorandum

Reconstructed Sell-Side Review of AkzoNobel's Southeast Asia Decorative
Paints Operations

Independent Student M&A Case Study | September 2026

Independent student analysis/reconstruction based on publicly available information. Not affiliated with, commissioned by, or representative of Goldman Sachs or AkzoNobel.

This document is a work product of an independent academic case study exercise. It is not an offering document, does not constitute investment advice, and should not be relied upon for any transactional or investment decision.

Table of Contents

1. Transaction Overview
2. Investment Highlights
3. Company / Asset Overview
4. Business Model
5. Products & Brands
6. Geographic Footprint
7. Southeast Asian Market
8. Competitive Landscape
9. Manufacturing / Operations
10. Distribution
11. Customers
12. Management
13. Historical Financials
14. Forecast Financials
15. Working Capital
16. Capex
17. Growth Opportunities
18. ESG / Regulatory Considerations
19. Valuation
20. Transaction Considerations
21. Risks
22. Appendix

SECTION 1

Transaction Overview

AkzoNobel N.V. (“AkzoNobel” or the “Seller”) has reportedly engaged Goldman Sachs to explore the sale of its Southeast Asian decorative paints operations, spanning Indonesia, Thailand, Malaysia and Vietnam (together, the “SEA Perimeter” or the “Company” for purposes of this memorandum). The process follows public comments by AkzoNobel's CEO, Greg Poux-Guillaume, in April 2026 regarding a potential divestiture of certain decorative paints businesses in the region.

Item	Detail	Classification
Seller	AkzoNobel N.V.	PUBLIC FACT
Reported Adviser	Goldman Sachs	PUBLIC FACT
Assets	Decorative paints operations: Indonesia, Thailand, Malaysia, Vietnam	PUBLIC FACT
Reported Revenue	EUR 300m (~USD 346m) annual	PUBLIC FACT
Process Timing	CEO comments Apr-2026; NBOs reportedly due mid-Sep-2026	PUBLIC FACT
Deal Structure	Whole-region or country-by-country sale, per source reporting	PUBLIC FACT
Named Bidder	Siam Cement Group (SCG), in preliminary discussions	PUBLIC FACT
Purchase Price Expectation	Not disclosed	UNAVAILABLE
Confirmed Bidder Shortlist	Not disclosed beyond SCG	UNAVAILABLE

Source: ION Analytics/Mergermarket, “AkzoNobel taps Goldman Sachs for sale of Southeast Asia paints assets” (SRC-001). See 01_Source_Data/Transaction_Research.md for the full source-classified fact table.

LIMITATION / CAUTION: This memorandum reconstructs a plausible information-memorandum structure from public data only. No confidential process information, management projections, or seller-provided figures were used or are implied to exist behind any figure in this document.

SECTION 2

Investment Highlights

- **Established multi-country platform.** Confirmed decorative-paints legal entities and manufacturing sites in all four target markets, each with a multi-decade operating history (Indonesia since 1971, Thailand since 1963).
- **Structural market growth.** The ASEAN paints and coatings market is projected to grow from USD 7.78bn (2026) to USD 9.92bn (2031), an implied ~5.0% CAGR, driven by construction activity, infrastructure investment and urbanization across the region.
- **Recognized brand equity.** Dulux brand presence across all four markets, alongside Eka and other AkzoNobel decorative product lines in Indonesia.
- **Structuring flexibility for buyers.** The Seller has reportedly signaled openness to a whole-region sale or a country-by-country sale to whichever buyer offers the greatest synergies in each market — a structure that could accommodate both global strategics and regional/local players.
- **Active, motivated buyer field.** Multiple global and regional strategics have evidenced overlap or stated interest, including Nippon Paint Holdings (confirmed decorative operations in all four markets) and Siam Cement Group (reported in preliminary discussions).

LIMITATION / CAUTION: These highlights are analyst-drafted narrative framing of disclosed facts and reasonable market context. They are not independently disclosed selling points from AkzoNobel or Goldman Sachs, and should not be read as such.

SECTION 3

Company / Asset Overview

The SEA Perimeter is reported to consist of AkzoNobel's Southeast Asian decorative paints operations. Based on the ION Analytics article's language, this memorandum treats the perimeter as Decorative Paints only in the four named countries — Performance Coatings facilities identified in the same countries are treated as an ANALYST INFERENCE to sit outside the perimeter, not a confirmed exclusion.

Confirmed legal entities

Country	Legal Entity (Decorative)	Established / Notes
Indonesia	PT ICI Paints Indonesia	Established 11-Aug-1971
Thailand	Akzo Nobel Paints (Thailand) Limited	Market entry 1963
Malaysia	Akzo Nobel Paints (Malaysia) Sdn Bhd	Formerly ICI Paints (Malaysia) Sdn Bhd
Vietnam	Akzo Nobel Paints Vietnam Ltd.	LEI: 5493001AA3NV7CRH5459

Source: 01_Source_Data/SEA_Asset_Perimeter.xlsx (SRC-003 through SRC-011).

LIMITATION / CAUTION: The exact transaction perimeter — which specific legal entities, brands, and shared-service functions would transfer — is not publicly confirmed. This section describes AkzoNobel's known SEA footprint, not a confirmed asset list for the transaction.

SECTION 4

Business Model

AkzoNobel's Decorative Paints segment globally operates a branded, manufacture-and-distribute model: in-house or contract manufacturing of paints and coatings, sold through a mix of dealer/distributor networks, home-improvement retail, and direct project/contractor channels, under the Dulux and other regional decorative brands. No SEA-specific business-model disclosure (e.g., % of sales through retail vs. trade channels, direct vs. distributor mix) is publicly available.

At the AkzoNobel Group level, the Decorative Paints segment generated EUR 4.09bn of revenue in FY2025 (15.8% adjusted EBITDA margin) against EUR 6.07bn for Performance Coatings (the other global segment) — illustrating that decorative paints is a material, though not the largest, share of AkzoNobel's overall portfolio.

LIMITATION / CAUTION: No SEA-specific business-model, channel-mix or customer-concentration disclosure exists publicly. This section describes the AkzoNobel Group Decorative Paints model generally as context, not a SEA-specific fact.

SECTION 5

Products & Brands

Country	Confirmed Brand(s) Present	Classification
Indonesia	Dulux, Sikkens, International, Eka	CONFIRMED presence; Sikkens/International are Performance Coatings brands, PROBABLE outside decorative perimeter
Thailand	Dulux	CONFIRMED
Malaysia	Dulux	CONFIRMED
Vietnam	Dulux (via Akzo Nobel Paints Vietnam Ltd.)	CONFIRMED

Source: 01_Source_Data/SEA_Asset_Perimeter.xlsx.

Certifications confirmed for the Indonesian operation include ISO 9001, ISO 14001 and Green Label Singapore; PT ICI Paints Indonesia is also a founding member of the Green Building Council Indonesia. Product-category-level detail (e.g., interior vs. exterior decorative, premium vs. mass-market tiering) is not publicly disclosed for the SEA operations specifically.

SECTION 6

Geographic Footprint

Country	Confirmed Decorative Site(s)	Other In-Country AkzoNobel Sites (likely non-decorative)
Indonesia	Tangerang	Cikarang (Performance/powder coatings; +40% capacity via EUR2.5m 2016 expansion)
Thailand	Bangkok (decorative + packaging coatings)	Nakhon Pathom, Rayong, Chon Buri (Performance Coatings)
Malaysia	Not independently confirmed this research pass	n/a
Vietnam	Ben Cat, Binh Duong (largest AkzoNobel site in Vietnam; 300+ employees; capacity expansion to 100m litres/year; LEED Gold certified)	Bac Ninh multi-site (EUR18.5m investment, powder coatings and consumer-electronics water-based line, inaugurated Mar-2024)

Source: 01_Source_Data/SEA_Asset_Perimeter.xlsx; Coatings World “A Snapshot of AkzoNobel Vietnam”; AkzoNobel press release on the Vietnam multi-site capacity expansion.

LIMITATION / CAUTION: Malaysia's decorative manufacturing site could not be confirmed against a primary source in the research underlying this project. Employee counts, production capacity and site-level financial data are not publicly available for any of the four countries' decorative operations specifically (Vietnam's 300+ employees and 100m litre capacity figure is the one site-level operating metric identified).

SECTION 7

Southeast Asian Market

The ASEAN paints and coatings market is reported to be growing from approximately USD 7.78bn in 2026 to approximately USD 9.92bn by 2031, an implied CAGR of approximately 5.0%. Growth is attributed to robust construction activity in Indonesia, Vietnam and Thailand, government-backed infrastructure investment, and regional industrial investment (including EV-related manufacturing, per one market summary).

Year	ASEAN Paints & Coatings Market (USD bn)
2026	7.78
2031E	9.92
Implied CAGR	~5.0%

Source: ION Analytics article, citing ASEAN paints and coatings market sizing (2026-2031). No underlying market-research report was independently sourced or verified in this project.

SECTION 8

Competitive Landscape

Competitor	Confirmed SEA Decorative Position
Nippon Paint	#2 in Malaysia decorative (26-year history); ~50% JV market share in Thailand decorative (trailing local leader Toa); decorative production near Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam; technical alliance in Indonesia
Toa (Thailand, local)	Reported to lead Thailand's decorative segment, ahead of the Nippon Paint JV's ~50% share
Asian Paints	Previously divested its Indonesian operations (sale to Omega Property Investments' Singapore arm, SGD 6.8m)
Berger Paints (Asian Paints group)	Manufacturing in Malaysia and Singapore; serves Indonesia, Vietnam, Brunei, Pacific islands
Siam Cement Group	Paint sold as one category within its Smart Living building-materials retail segment across all four markets

Source: search aggregation of company/trade-press disclosures (afaqs, Business Standard, coatings trade press) — not independently verified against each company's own primary filings in every case. See 06_Buyer_Analysis/Buyer_Fit_Matrix.xlsx for full evidence citations.

SECTION 9

Manufacturing / Operations

Confirmed manufacturing operations are limited to the sites identified in Section 6. The Vietnam site (Ben Cat, Binh Duong) is the only facility with disclosed capacity (up to 100m litres/year) and headcount (300+ employees) specific to decorative paints. No production volume, capacity utilization, unit economics or manufacturing cost data is publicly disclosed for any of the four countries.

LIMITATION / CAUTION: Manufacturing operating metrics beyond the Vietnam site's capacity/headcount are UNAVAILABLE / NOT PUBLICLY DISCLOSED. Any manufacturing-footprint synergy discussion elsewhere in this memorandum or the companion Buyer_Analysis workbook is qualitative and illustrative, not derived from site-level cost data.

SECTION 10

Distribution

No SEA-specific distribution-channel data (number of dealers, retail doors, direct vs. trade sales split) is publicly disclosed. By analogy to AkzoNobel's global Decorative Paints business and general industry practice, the business likely sells through a mix of independent paint dealers, home-improvement retail, and direct contractor/project channels, but this is a general industry inference, not a SEA-specific disclosed fact.

LIMITATION / CAUTION: Distribution-channel mix, dealer counts and retail penetration are UNAVAILABLE / NOT PUBLICLY DISCLOSED for the SEA decorative perimeter.

SECTION 11

Customers

No customer-level or customer-concentration data is publicly disclosed for the SEA decorative perimeter. Decorative paints businesses of this type typically serve a fragmented customer base (individual consumers, contractors, and retail/dealer intermediaries) rather than a small number of large accounts, which is a general industry characteristic rather than a company-specific disclosed fact.

LIMITATION / CAUTION: Customer concentration and any customer-level contractual arrangements are UNAVAILABLE / NOT PUBLICLY DISCLOSED.

SECTION 12

Management

No SEA-perimeter-specific management team, organizational structure, or leadership continuity information is publicly disclosed. At the AkzoNobel Group level, Greg Poux-Guillaume serves as CEO and is the source of the April 2026 public comments that reportedly initiated this process.

LIMITATION / CAUTION: Country-level or regional SEA management structure, headcount, and retention/continuity plans are UNAVAILABLE / NOT PUBLICLY DISCLOSED — a material open item for any actual buyer's diligence process.

SECTION 13

Historical Financials

AkzoNobel does not publicly disclose SEA-decorative-specific historical financial statements. The only public data point is the reported FY2025 revenue of EUR 300m (ION Analytics). FY2023 and FY2024 figures below are ANALYST CALCULATIONS, back-solved from the FY2025 anchor using an illustrative historical growth rate assumption anchored to the ASEAN paints market CAGR — they are not observed historical actuals.

Metric (EUR mm)	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025
Revenue	273.9	286.3	300.0
EBITDA margin %	13.0%	14.2%*	15.8%*
EBITDA	35.6	40.6	47.4

**FY2024/FY2025 EBITDA margins are set equal to AkzoNobel's actual, publicly disclosed GLOBAL Decorative Paints segment adjusted EBITDA margin (14.2% and 15.8% respectively) as a SEA proxy — a modeling choice, not a confirmed SEA-specific figure. Source: 02_Financial_Model/README and Assumptions tab.*

***LIMITATION / CAUTION:** Every figure in this table beyond the EUR 300m FY2025 revenue anchor is either an ANALYST CALCULATION or an ILLUSTRATIVE ASSUMPTION. No SEA-specific historical financial statements have been published by AkzoNobel.*

SECTION 14

Forecast Financials

The table below summarizes the illustrative 5-year carve-out forecast built in 02_Financial_Model. All figures are ILLUSTRATIVE ASSUMPTIONS constructed from the single public revenue anchor — see that workbook's README for full methodology and the Assumptions tab for every input's source/rationale.

Metric (EUR mm)	FY2026E	FY2027E	FY2028E	FY2029E	FY2030E
Revenue	315.0	331.4	347.9	364.7	381.4
EBITDA margin %	16.5%	17.0%	17.5%	17.8%	18.0%
EBITDA	52.0	56.3	60.9	64.9	68.7
Unlevered FCF	21.3	32.1	36.9	39.6	42.1

Source: 02_Financial_Model/Project_Southeast_Asia_Financial_Model.xlsx (Revenue_Build, Carveout_PnL tabs).

LIMITATION / CAUTION: This forecast is a carve-out reconstruction for illustrative case-study purposes. It is not a management projection, and no forward-looking statement of AkzoNobel's is being represented or implied.

SECTION 15

Working Capital

Working capital is modeled using illustrative, industry-typical paints-distribution payment terms, since no SEA-specific balance-sheet data is publicly available.

Assumption	Value	Basis
Days Sales Outstanding (DSO)	45 days	Illustrative — typical trade-distribution terms for regional paints businesses
Days Inventory Outstanding (DIO)	60 days	Illustrative — typical finished-goods + raw-material cover
Days Payable Outstanding (DPO)	45 days	Illustrative — typical supplier terms for resin/pigment/packaging inputs
NWC / Revenue	~14.6% (all years)	ANALYST CALCULATION from the above day counts

Source: 02_Financial_Model/Working_Capital tab and Assumptions tab, Section 7.

SECTION 16

Capex

Capex is modeled at an illustrative 3.0% of revenue in the base run-rate (typical paints-industry maintenance capex benchmark), elevated to 3.5% of revenue in FY2026E-FY2027E to reflect illustrative separation-related capex (standalone ERP/systems build-out, facility rebranding) associated with a carve-out. D&A is modeled at a flat illustrative 2.5% of revenue.

LIMITATION / CAUTION: No AkzoNobel SEA-decorative-specific capex, D&A or fixed-asset disclosure exists publicly. All capex/D&A figures in this memorandum and the companion financial model are ILLUSTRATIVE ASSUMPTIONS.

SECTION 17

Growth Opportunities

- **Underlying market growth.** ASEAN paints and coatings market growth of ~5.0% CAGR (2026-2031) provides a structural tailwind independent of any company-specific initiative.
- **Vietnam capacity.** The Ben Cat, Binh Duong site's expansion to 100m litres/year of capacity suggests committed growth investment in one of the fastest-growing SEA construction markets.
- **Buyer-specific synergy potential.** Strategic buyers with existing regional manufacturing or distribution scale (e.g., Nippon Paint in Malaysia/Thailand, SCG's ASEAN retail network) could unlock cost and revenue synergies beyond the standalone forecast — see 06_Buyer_Analysis/Synergy_Analysis.xlsx for illustrative, methodology-disclosed sizing.
- **Country-by-country optionality.** A split-sale structure could allow each country's operations to be matched with the buyer best positioned to accelerate growth there, rather than requiring a single one-size-fits-all acquirer.

SECTION 18

ESG / Regulatory Considerations

PT ICI Paints Indonesia holds ISO 9001 and ISO 14001 certification and Green Label Singapore status, and is a founding member of the Green Building Council Indonesia. The Ben Cat, Binh Duong (Vietnam) facility is the first paints and coatings facility in Vietnam to receive LEED Gold certification from the U.S. Green Building Council, and is reported to be pursuing LOTUS certification from the Vietnam Green Building Council.

Regulatory / competition considerations

A sale to a buyer with substantial existing decorative-paints market share in the same countries — most notably Nippon Paint, given its #2 position in Malaysia and ~50% JV share of Thailand's decorative segment — would raise materially higher merger-control/competition-review risk in those specific markets than a sale to a buyer with limited existing overlap. This is an analyst assessment based on evidenced market share, not a confirmed regulatory outcome or filing.

LIMITATION / CAUTION: No confirmed regulatory filing, merger-control clearance requirement, or specific competition-authority engagement has been identified for this process. Assessment above is illustrative based on evidenced market-share overlap only.

SECTION 19

Valuation

Enterprise Value has been triangulated across three methodologies — Discounted Cash Flow, Trading Comparables, and Precedent Transactions — built out in 02_Financial_Model, 03_Trading_Comps, 04_Precedent_Transactions and consolidated in 05_Valuation.

LIMITATION / CAUTION: Data refresh (2026-09-18): the DCF's WACC beta and the entire Trading Comps dataset were updated from illustrative/secondary-aggregator placeholders to live market data (Yahoo Finance via yfinance, single consistent pull across all 6 peers). The figures below reflect that refresh.

Methodology	Low (EUR mm)	Mid (EUR mm)	High (EUR mm)
DCF (WACC/terminal-growth sensitivity)	468	613	908
Trading Comps — EV/Revenue basis	570	890	1,293
Trading Comps — EV/EBITDA basis	535	792	1,360
Precedent Transactions	87	690	578
RECOMMENDED PRIMARY RANGE	500	625	775

Source: 05_Valuation/Project_Southeast_Asia_Valuation.xlsx (Triangulation tab). WACC 8.88% (beta 0.821, live peer median); Trading Comps complete across all 6 peers, no exclusions.

The recommended primary range (EUR 500-775mm, midpoint EUR 625mm) is anchored on the DCF base case (EUR 613mm, using a WACC of 8.88% built with a real peer-median beta of 0.821) and cross-checked against the two most structurally comparable data points identified: the Sherwin-Williams / BASF Suvinil precedent (a global strategic acquiring a single-country emerging-market decorative paints carve-out) and the Nippon Paint / AkzoNobel Decorative Paints rejected global offer. Trading comparables (now complete across all 6 peers with no exclusions) imply a higher range, still substantially influenced by Asian Paints' rich India-market EV/EBITDA multiple, and are treated as directional context rather than a primary driver.

Equity Value cannot be calculated: AkzoNobel does not publicly disclose asset-level debt or cash for the SEA decorative carve-out. Enterprise Value is presented as the primary valuation output throughout this project.

LIMITATION / CAUTION: The valuation range rests on a financial model built almost entirely from ILLUSTRATIVE ASSUMPTIONS, since no SEA-specific EBITDA, margin, working-capital or balance-sheet data is publicly disclosed for this asset. It should be treated as illustrative and provisional, not as a fairness opinion or an actual bid range.

SECTION 20

Transaction Considerations

Structure options

- **Option A — Single regional sale:** one buyer acquires all four country platforms as a combined SEA decorative business. Simpler execution (single SPA, single diligence process) but requires a buyer with pan-regional infrastructure or appetite.
- **Option B — Country-by-country sale:** each country sold separately to whichever local/regional buyer offers the greatest synergies there, explicitly contemplated in the source reporting. More complex execution (multiple SPAs, parallel processes, potential timing mismatch) but preserves optionality and could maximize aggregate proceeds if country-specific buyers pay a premium for their best-fit market.

Reported process timeline

CEO comments regarding a potential SEA divestiture were made in April 2026. Non-binding offers were reportedly due by mid-September 2026. No signing, exclusivity, or closing timeline has been publicly disclosed beyond the NBO deadline.

LIMITATION / CAUTION: No information is publicly available on process mechanics (single- vs. two-stage auction), management presentation timing, data room access, or expected signing/closing dates.

SECTION 21

Risks

Risk Category	Description
Financial data scarcity	No SEA-specific EBITDA, margin, working capital or balance-sheet data is publicly disclosed — every valuation output in this memorandum rests on illustrative assumptions.
Regulatory / antitrust	A sale to a buyer with deep existing overlap (e.g., Nippon Paint in Malaysia/Thailand) could face material merger-control scrutiny in those specific markets.
Perimeter uncertainty	Whether Performance Coatings assets, shared services, or specific brands (e.g., Eka) transfer with the decorative business is not publicly confirmed.
Multi-country execution complexity	A country-by-country sale structure multiplies regulatory approvals, SPAs and closing-condition risk across four jurisdictions.
Carve-out execution risk	TSA dependency, stranded costs and standalone-systems build-out carry real integration risk not sized by any public disclosure.
Valuation dispersion	DCF, trading comparables and precedent transactions do not converge — a genuine finding that widens the defensible pricing range rather than a modeling artifact.
Market data reliability	Trading comparables data was gathered via secondary aggregators (no market data terminal access) and showed material cross-source inconsistencies (see 03_Trading_Comps/README).

SECTION 22

Appendix

A. Project workbook index

Folder	Contents
01_Source_Data	Transaction_Research.md; SEA_Asset_Perimeter.xlsx/.md
02_Financial_Model	Project_Southeast_Asia_Financial_Model.xlsx (carve-out P&L, working capital, capex/D&A, DCF)
03_Trading_Comps	Project_Southeast_Asia_Trading_Comps.xlsx
04_Precedent_Transactions	Project_Southeast_Asia_Precedents.xlsx
05_Valuation	Project_Southeast_Asia_Valuation.xlsx (triangulation, equity bridge)
06_Buyer_Analysis	Project_Southeast_Asia_Buyer_Analysis.xlsx
07_Pitch_Deck	Project_Southeast_Asia_Sell_Side_Pitch.pptx
08_Information_Memorandum	This document

B. Key source references

Source ID	Source
SRC-001	ION Analytics/Mergermarket, "AkzoNobel taps Goldman Sachs for sale of Southeast Asia paints assets"
SRC-003 to SRC-014	AkzoNobel SEA country operations — Dulux country sites, Coatings World, LEI Register, AkzoNobel press releases
SRC-013, SRC-015	AkzoNobel FY2025 results release; PCI Magazine Global Top 10 coverage
SRC-016	OECD Corporate Tax Statistics 2026; Trading Economics; PwC Tax Summaries

Full source log with URLs: 10_Supporting_Research/Support_Sources.xlsx.

C. Disclaimer

Independent student analysis/reconstruction based on publicly available information. Not affiliated with, commissioned by, or representative of Goldman Sachs or AkzoNobel. This document was prepared without access to a live market-data terminal, confidential management information, or any non-public AkzoNobel disclosure. Every material figure is classified in its source workbook as PUBLIC FACT, ANALYST CALCULATION, ILLUSTRATIVE ASSUMPTION, or UNAVAILABLE / NOT PUBLICLY DISCLOSED.